AI for Commercial Real Estate: Agentic Engineering as a Management Skill

Course Overview

You already know how to do agentic engineering. You just don't know it yet.

Every time you take a project from site selection to occupancy, you follow an engineering process: discover the opportunity, plan the feasibility, design the concept, detail the specs, build, inspect, commission, and document with as-builts. Every time you prepare a deal, you produce a documentation chain: pro forma, investment committee memo, rent roll, underwriting criteria. Every time you manage a construction project, you decompose tasks into scopes of work, schedule the critical path, inspect the output, and iterate through design development until it meets standards.

These are not metaphors. They are the same skills — applied to AI instead of buildings. **And they're the foundation for a new set of skills** — prompt engineering, context assembly, AI diagnostics, and frontier calibration — that you'll build during this workshop.

AI for CRE is a four-day workshop spread across two weekends (Saturday-Sunday, week gap, Saturday-Sunday) that teaches agentic engineering — the discipline of designing, building, and managing multi-step AI workflows — through the real estate management frameworks you already use every day. Using Claude Code as the hands-on platform, you'll move beyond single-turn chatbot prompting into structured workflows that produce reliable, professional-grade output for your actual CRE tasks. The week gap between weekends isn't downtime — it's where you apply Weekend 1's frameworks to real work, so you return to Weekend 2 with authentic questions and hands-on experience.

You'll leave with a **working CRE workflow plugin** for a recurring task from your own work — a self-contained tool you'll refine over the following weeks into a production-ready automation. Not a theoretical exercise, but a working prototype that saves you real time on real work.

Who Should Attend

This workshop is designed for:

- **Brokers** who want AI to handle comp research, market updates, and LOI drafting while they focus on relationships and deal strategy
- **Property managers** who need reliable workflows for lease administration, tenant communications, and monthly reporting
- **Asset managers** looking to automate portfolio analysis, variance reporting, and renewal strategy preparation
- **Analysts** who want to move from manual data processing to AI-assisted market intelligence and due diligence support

Prerequisites: Basic familiarity with single-turn desktop chatbots (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude). You should have used a chatbot enough that basic prompting is comfortable — typically 10+ sessions for real tasks, not just casual experimentation. No coding or technical background required.

Experience Level: Intermediate. You've used AI for simple tasks — drafting emails, answering questions, analyzing files, basic research — but you haven't been able to make it produce consistent, professional-grade repeatable multi-step workflows that don't require constant back and forth with the chatbot. This course bridges that gap.

This course is NOT for: - Complete AI beginners (consider CRE-101 first) - People looking for a plug-and-play solution that requires no thinking (i.e can I copy your best prompts? No, but you can learn the process to create your own.) - Anyone not willing to bring real work tasks to practice on (you learn by solving real problems, not by doing hypothetical exercises) - People who want to learn coding or technical implementation details (this is about workflow design and management, not coding -- think architect, not builder)

What You'll Learn

By the end of this workshop, you will be able to:

- **Recognize the three roles you already play** — Product Manager, Engineer, Designer — and apply them deliberately to AI workflow design (the same way you act as development/asset manager, architect, and GC on your projects)
- **Understand the three eras of AI discipline** — from prompt engineering (where most people are stuck) to context engineering (managing what AI knows) to intent engineering (encoding your goals, constraints, and decision boundaries so the AI

knows how to decide, not just what to know) — and why your documentation chain IS the competitive advantage

- **Diagnose why AI output fails** using a four-pillar framework (Context, Model, Prompt, Tools) that maps to the four things that determine the quality of any construction project
- **Validate before you build** — apply a paired value-delivery fit analysis that checks two things: does this workflow address real user jobs and pains (the same way you'd assess tenant needs before designing a space), and can your system actually deliver the promised value (the same way you'd assess whether a building can deliver what the lease promises)? Plus a quick cost sniff test — the back-of-envelope pro forma for AI workflows
- **Follow a structured 8-step process** from discovery to documentation — the same development lifecycle you already know, applied to AI workflows — and produce a requirements document that defines what you're building, what success looks like, and what's off limits (your scoreboard and guardrails, built into the plan from Day 1)
- **Break complex CRE processes into delegable units** with clear human checkpoints, the same way you create a work breakdown structure for a construction project
- **Assemble context** the way you assemble a due diligence package — so the AI has everything it needs to produce quality output
- **Use Claude Code** — agents, skills, slash commands, and plugins — to execute multi-step CRE workflows hands-on, while learning to read the design documents that structure real workflows
- **Know where AI stops and your judgment starts** — frontier recognition, the same highest-and-best-use analysis you do for every site
- **Define "done" before you start building** — write acceptance criteria that let you evaluate AI output objectively, distinguishing between hard requirements ("does it include all critical dates?" — either it does or it doesn't, like a building inspection) and quality standards ("is the analysis accurate and complete?" — a matter of professional judgment, like an appraisal), then refine through iterative cycles until it meets your professional standards
- **Build a working Claude Code plugin** for a recurring CRE task you take back to work — your capstone deliverable, a self-contained plugin you'll refine into a production tool
- **Map the CRE metaphor** — what exactly is a lease term sheet in agentic engineering terms? What about a rent roll? A variance report? You'll build a complete reference

map — the CRE Metaphor Map — that translates every CRE process and document into the language of agentic engineering, so you always know which concept you're working with

A note on the reverse transfer: The disciplines you learn here — defining success before execution, writing acceptance criteria before reviewing output, decomposing tasks with review checkpoints — don't just make you better at managing AI. They make you a more effective manager of people. The OFD you write for an AI workflow is equally powerful when you delegate to a junior analyst. Most managers skip these steps with human teams too. After this course, you won't.

A note on durability: We use Claude Code as the hands-on platform, and you'll learn its specific vocabulary — agents, skills, slash commands, plugins. But the emphasis is on what these concepts *are*, not on memorizing syntax. Every agentic platform has its own implementation of the same ideas: OpenAI's Codex and Google Gemini CLI have Agent Skills, and whatever ships next quarter will have its own version of the same building blocks. The vocabulary changes; the concepts don't. You're learning how to think in workflows, break down processes, and translate your experience into specifications written in plain English. The workflow thinking, the documentation chain, the decomposition and diagnostic skills — these transfer to any AI agent platform that emerges. Even the Skills you write in Claude Code are structured English, not code. The thinking is the skill. The tool is just where you practice it.

Workshop Format

Duration: 4-day, two weekends (Sat-Sun + week gap + Sat-Sun; ~17 hours total)

Delivery: In-person intensive workshop with hands-on practice

Learning Approach: The workshop splits roughly 50/50 between **concept and design work** (frameworks, handwritten workflow plans, design documents on paper) and **Claude Code hands-on** (delegating tasks, reviewing outputs, diagnosing failures, iterating in real time). This is deliberate. The most common failure mode in agentic engineering isn't bad prompting — it's rushing past design. When you let the tool think through too much of the design for you, you don't realize your intent was lost until you're staring at a finished implementation that solves the wrong problem. The design-on-paper discipline forces you to externalize what you actually want *before* the tool starts making decisions on your behalf.

Weekend 1, Day 1 (Saturday): Foundations & Mental Models

You'll learn the three eras of AI discipline — from prompting to context to intent — and discover you already use most of these skills under different names.

- **Orientation:** Where you are now, where you're going, and the three eras of AI work (prompting → context → intent)
- **The Holy Trinity:** the three roles you already play, applied to AI
- **The Four Pillars:** why AI output fails and how to fix it
- *Consolidation:* connect these frameworks to a real task from your own work
- **Value-delivery fit:** does this workflow address real needs? can the system deliver? plus a cost sniff test
- **Extended practice:** refine your value-delivery analysis with peer feedback

Weekend 1, Day 2 (Sunday): Process & Design

You'll build the planning documents that turn ideas into structured, buildable specifications — the intent engineering that tells AI how to decide, not just what to know.

- **The 8-step process + PRD:** the development lifecycle for AI workflows, starting with your objective function — your scoreboard and guardrails
- **Task decomposition:** breaking CRE processes into delegable scopes of work
- *Consolidation:* integrate everything around a single workflow design
- **Context assembly:** due diligence for AI — give it what it needs to succeed
- **Build-ready checkpoint:** verify your complete design chain before the week gap
- **Homework briefing:** try building a simple skill during the week

Week Gap (5 business days)

Apply Weekend 1 frameworks to real work. Try Claude Code on your own. The productive struggle during the week makes Weekend 2 click — participants who attempt and fail to build something arrive Day 3 with the most valuable questions.

Weekend 2, Day 3 (Saturday): Tools & Analysis

You'll get hands-on with Claude Code and learn to diagnose problems — including the ones you hit during the week.

- **Week-in-review:** share what you tried, what worked, what didn't
- **Claude Code fundamentals:** agents, skills, slash commands, plugins — plus a live demo of what happens when you rush past design (spoiler: context without intent is a loaded weapon with no target)
- **Diagnosing failures & knowing your limits:** when output is wrong, knowing which pillar to fix — and knowing which tasks to keep human (your "Capability Map")
- *Consolidation:* revisit your Weekend 1 design with an analytical lens
- **Extended lab:** diagnose failures in your own workflows from the week

Weekend 2, Day 4 (Sunday): Quality & Synthesis

You'll define what "done" looks like, build your capstone plugin, and present it to peers.

- **Quality judgment & acceptance criteria:** define "done" before you build, then refine through iterative cycles
- **Capstone build:** build a working CRE workflow plugin for a recurring task from your own work
- **Capstone polish:** refine your plugin against your own acceptance criteria
- **Presentations & peer feedback:** live demos and structured rubric feedback
- **Course closing:** why intent infrastructure — the skills you just learned — is the durable competitive advantage

What's Included

During the workshop: - Comprehensive workshop workbook with all frameworks, templates, and exercises - CRE Metaphor Map reference card — the complete mapping of agentic engineering to real estate parallels, including role-specific tracks for brokers, property managers, asset managers, and analysts - Documentation chain templates (PRD, TDD) in CRE-native language - Paired VPD worksheet — business and engineering value-delivery fit templates with cross-layer traceability checklist - Task decomposition and workflow design templates - Access to course GitHub repository with all templates and examples

Post-course reinforcement: - **Week 1 Challenge:** A specific, bounded task to complete in your first week back — one decomposed task using one framework from the course. Not the full capstone, but a concrete first win. - **Diagnostic one-pager:** A quick-reference card for your desk — "When AI output is wrong, check these four things." The

distilled Four Pillars diagnostic you can use without opening the workbook. - **Week 2 email:** A new practice scenario (5-10 minutes) to keep the frameworks fresh - **Week 4:** One 15-minute office hours call — bring a specific problem or workflow question - **Week 8 follow-up survey:** Which frameworks are you actually using? What's working? What's not? - **60-day email Q&A support** for course-related questions

What to Bring

- Laptop with internet access (reliable WiFi required — see Technology Requirements below)
- Claude Code subscription (Claude Pro or Teams, $20/month) — **set up before the workshop** (see below)
- 2-3 real work tasks you want to automate (anonymized if needed)
- Willingness to practice with real work, not hypotheticals

What to Prepare

Before the workshop, please complete these steps:

1. **Pre-course survey** (5 min): You'll receive a link after registration. This helps the instructor tailor examples to your specific CRE role and AI experience level.

2. **Install Claude Code** (15-30 min): Follow the setup guide sent with your registration confirmation. If you run into issues, email [support address] — we'll help you troubleshoot before the workshop so we don't lose class time.

3. **Select 2-3 work tasks** you'd like to automate. Good candidates are:

4. Recurring tasks you do weekly or monthly (lease abstracts, variance reports, market updates)
5. Tasks that follow a predictable structure but require CRE judgment

6. Tasks you'd delegate to a capable junior if you had one

7. **Anonymize sensitive data** if needed: Replace tenant names with "[Tenant A]", specific dollar amounts with rounded figures, and any confidential terms with generic equivalents. AI doesn't need to know the actual tenant name to analyze a lease structure.

Technology Requirements

- **Internet:** The venue provides high-speed WiFi. Claude Code requires a stable internet connection for all participants simultaneously. If you experience connectivity issues during the workshop, the instructor will provide offline alternatives for affected exercises.
- **Claude Code subscription:** Claude Pro ($20/month) or Claude Teams. You must have an active subscription before arriving — the workshop exercises require it.
- **Fallback plan:** If Claude Code experiences service disruptions during the workshop, affected exercises will shift to instructor-demonstrated walkthroughs with participant follow-along using the workbook templates. No exercise depends on every participant having simultaneous active sessions.
- **Browser:** A modern web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge). No additional software installation required beyond Claude Code.

About the Instructor

Reggie Chan

Principal, Tenebrus Capital

Reggie Chan is a commercial real estate professional with 15+ years in asset management, development, and consulting. As VP of Asset Management at Artis REIT, he used process engineering to outperform competitors with six times his headcount — achieving the highest actual rents in his submarket while maintaining non-negotiable family commitments.

Today, through Tenebrus Capital, Reggie helps CRE professionals and organizations build AI capabilities that deliver real results. He holds the PGCV (Professional Guideline Certification in Valuation) and Andrew Ng's Machine Learning Specialization, combining deep real estate expertise with practical AI implementation experience.

Reggie's approach comes from a core insight: the skills that make you effective at managing real estate projects are the foundation for the skills that make you effective at engineering AI workflows. This course exists because nobody else is teaching it that way.

Course Details

- **Course Code:** CRE-201
- **Duration:** 4-day, two weekends (Sat-Sun + week gap + Sat-Sun)
- **Format:** In-person
- **Class Size:** 12-20 participants
- **Level:** Intermediate
- **Series:** CRE AI for CRE Curriculum

Registration Information

[To be added: pricing, dates, location, registration link]

Short Description (for catalogs and listings)

You already know how to do agentic engineering — you just call it project management. **AI for CRE** is a four-day workshop across two weekends that teaches commercial real estate professionals to design multi-step AI workflows using the management frameworks they already practice: the development lifecycle becomes the engineering process, deal documentation becomes the planning chain, and project management becomes AI management. Hands-on with Claude Code. Walk away with a working plugin you'll refine into a real tool. No coding required — and the intent engineering that makes your workflows converge on the right answer.

Social Media Version

The 8-step AI engineering process? It's the development lifecycle — site selection to occupancy. The planning documents? They're your pro forma, IC memo, rent roll, and underwriting. You already know how to do this. And we'll teach you the new skills that make it work for AI. 4-day across two weekends. Hands-on. CRE-specific. Context tells AI what to know. Intent tells it how to decide. We teach both.

Internal Notes (Not for public)

Marketing & Differentiation: See `course-positioning.md` §The Core Insight and §Market Differentiation for the full strategic framing. Key hook: "You already know how to do this" balanced with "And here's what's genuinely new."

Objection Handling: - "I'm not technical" — "You don't need to be. If you can manage a construction project, you can engineer an AI workflow." - "I've tried AI courses before" — "Were they taught in your language? Every concept maps to something you already do." - "Is this just about ChatGPT?" — "ChatGPT is single-turn prompting. This is multi-step workflow engineering using Claude Code." - "Will I really be able to use this on Monday?" — "You'll leave with a working plugin that needs 2-4 hours of refinement before it's production-ready. Plus a Week 1 Challenge that gives you a concrete first win. You won't be an expert on Monday, but you'll have a clear path and a working prototype to build on." - "What if Claude gets replaced by something else?" — "We use Claude Code because it's the best hands-on platform right now. But every concept you learn — agents, skills, slash commands, plugins — exists in every agentic platform. OpenAI's Codex has skills. Google's tools have agents. The vocabulary differs; the thinking is the same. If a better tool comes along next year, you plug it in. The people who only learned prompting tricks start over. You don't." - "Four days? That's a big commitment" — "It's two weekends, not four consecutive days. The week gap is where the magic happens — you apply Weekend 1's frameworks to real work, so Weekend 2 isn't theory, it's refinement of something you've already tried. Participants consistently say the week gap made the capstone dramatically better."

Target Enrollment: 12-20 per cohort (optimal for hands-on facilitation)

Version History

- v0.1.0 (2026-02-06): Initial course description
- v0.2.0 (2026-02-20): Incorporated pedagogical review. Reframed "Monday-ready" claims. Updated schedule to 9 objectives with integration pauses. Added pre-course survey, technology requirements, setup instructions, and post-course reinforcement plan (Week 1 Challenge, spaced repetition, diagnostic one-pager).
- v0.2.1 (2026-02-23): Clarified concept-vs-syntax philosophy. Integrated OFD into PRD learning objective. Added TDD/EDD distinction to acceptance criteria objective. Renamed DDD to "Domain Data Dictionary." Updated 50/50 learning approach

(concept-design vs. Claude Code hands-on). Updated objection handling and durability note for cross-platform framing.

- v0.2.2 (2026-02-23): P0 fixes from course-description-review.md. Rewrote "What You'll Learn" bullets to lead with CRE concepts (removed PRD, TDD, EDD acronyms from customer-facing copy — replaced with building inspection vs. appraisal parallel and CRE-native language). Aligned prerequisite language across all planning documents. Flagged duration as pending per Gratton directive (design for completeness first).
- v0.2.3 (2026-02-23): Claude Code components reduced from 5 to 4 (dropped Tools/Scripts, renamed Commands to Slash Commands). Capstone reframed from "workflow design draft" to "working CRE workflow plugin" throughout. Updated component lists, Day 2 schedule, short description, and objection handling.
- v0.3.0 (2026-02-25): Added VPD/BMC integration. New bullet in "What You'll Learn" (value-delivery fit). Updated Day 1 schedule with VPD block. Added paired VPD worksheet to "What's Included."
- v0.4.0 (2026-02-25): Updated to 4-day two-weekend format. Resolved PENDING duration. Restructured Day 1-2 schedule into Weekend 1 Day 1-2, Week Gap, Weekend 2 Day 3-4. Added intent engineering vocabulary (three-era framing, Capability Map). Updated short description, social media, course details, and objection handling for new format.
- v0.4.1 (2026-02-25): Cross-file deduplication. Internal Notes marketing angle and competitive differentiation replaced with cross-ref to course-positioning.md. Objection handling retained (unique to this file).
- v0.4.2 (2026-02-25): Within-file deduplication. Removed duplicate "productive struggle" phrase from homework briefing (already stated in Week Gap section). Removed duplicate "bring 2-3 tasks" instruction from Learning Approach (already in What to Bring and What to Prepare).
- v0.5.0 (2026-02-25): Added reverse transfer note after "What You'll Learn" — agentic engineering discipline (OFD, TDD, decomposition) transfers to human team management. Student-facing framing.